

The Fixer's Desk Operating Model

Version 3.3 - Canonical

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Purpose

This document defines the authoritative operating model of **The Fixer's Desk**, Hollin's problem-first initiative for turning observed human problems into governed Cases, founder decisions, built solutions, market activity, and continuous improvement.

It governs solo operation by **Deidra + Alex**. It is subordinate to the Hollin Company Specification, Hollin Problem-First Doctrine, Hollin Organizational Architecture, and accepted architecture decisions. Department specifications, system specifications, workflows, and implementation plans must conform to this model.

Operating Participants

Deidra - Founder and Director

Deidra is the founder and constitutional authority of The Fixer's Desk. She holds final authority over organizational direction, portfolio decisions, product authorization, releases, exceptions, and retirement unless explicitly delegated.

Alex - Institutional AI Operating Partner

Alex is the institutional AI operating partner of The Fixer's Desk, currently fulfilled by **ChatGPT** under Deidra's authority.

Alex performs delegated nonhuman operational work across the organization, including observation, research support, synthesis, documentation, record maintenance, workflow advancement, preparation of decision packages, and institutional memory. Alex may recommend and prepare work but may not fabricate evidence, erase governed history, or exercise founder authority. Decisions reserved to Deidra always require an explicit founder response.

If, in the future, another AI system fulfills this role, the institutional responsibilities remain attached to the role of **Alex**, not to any particular software implementation.

Operating identity

Founding Principle

The Fixer's Desk finds messy real-world problems people have accepted as "just the way it is," then designs cleaner, more elegant solutions.

The Fixer's Desk is not a generic product factory and does not begin with unsupported ideas. It begins with evidence of human problems.

Its operating objective is to maintain a reliable institutional loop that can:

- observe and preserve credible problem signals;
- develop governed Cases as organizational assets;
- present decision-ready work to Deidra;
- turn selected solution paths into useful, maintainable products or other interventions;
- place approved products into the market;
- receive feedback, complaints, outcomes, and improvement evidence; and
- return that learning to the correct upstream department without losing history.

The initial production objective is **50 founder-ready Cases placed in The Director's Office**. The governing operational command is:

Alex, make 50 Cases and put them in my office.

Solo operating model

The current system is optimized for two operating participants:

Deidra - Founder and Director

Deidra holds final constitutional, portfolio, investment, product-authorization, release, exception, and retirement authority unless she explicitly delegates it.

Deidra should primarily operate from **The Director's Office**, not by manually running every departmental back office. Her normal work is to review prepared decisions, set direction, approve or return work, resolve escalations, and exercise founder authority.

Alex - Institutional operator

Alex performs delegated nonhuman operating work across the six departments: observation, capture, classification, research support, synthesis, record maintenance, workflow advancement, documentation, preparation of decision packages, task reconciliation, and retrieval.

Alex may recommend and prepare, but may not fabricate evidence, erase governed history, or exercise founder authority. Decisions reserved to Deidra require an explicit founder response.

Separation of responsibilities

Deidra and Alex may occupy many institutional roles in practice, but the responsibilities remain distinct. Each action must be attributable to the department and authority under which it occurred so that future delegation does not require redesigning the operating model.

Six institutional departments

The Fixer's Desk operates through six stable departments.

1. The Watch

Mission: Observe the world for credible signals of human problems and preserve them before they disappear.

The Watch owns environmental observation, signal capture, source preservation, early pattern recognition, and the initial recommendation that a signal deserves Case consideration.

The Watch does not decide that a product should exist. It supplies traceable observations to Casework.

Primary handoff: supported problem signals and source evidence to Casework.

2. Casework

Mission: Convert credible problem signals into governed, decision-ready Cases.

Casework is the canonical custody system for Cases. It owns intake, triage, investigation, evidence baselines, dispositions, founder-review preparation, solution-path assessment, Product Brief authorization, Case history, and controlled closure or reopening.

A Case is governed knowledge about a human problem and remains an organizational asset whether or not a product is built.

Casework may conclude that the correct result is research, referral, education, a non-product intervention, no current intervention, or closure. Product creation is conditional rather than presumed.

Primary handoff: decision-ready Cases and governed founder-review packages to The Director's Office; authorized Product Briefs to The Forge.

3. The Director's Office

Mission: Serve as Deidra's primary operating, prioritization, and decision surface.

The Director's Office presents prepared work requiring founder judgment without creating duplicate sources of truth. It consolidates queues, recommendations, evidence summaries, decisions, escalations, portfolio conditions, and cross-department direction.

The Director's Office is where Deidra normally:

- reviews decision-ready Cases;
- approves, returns, redirects, pauses, or closes work;
- authorizes solution paths and Product Briefs;
- sets portfolio priorities and capacity exceptions;
- approves releases, major changes, and retirements; and
- directs work across departments.

The Director's Office does not own the underlying Case, build, market, or feedback records. It projects authoritative departmental records into one governed decision surface.

Primary handoff: explicit founder decisions and operating direction to the responsible department.

4. The Forge

Mission: Turn authorized solution work into validated, versioned, releasable products and interventions.

The Forge owns requirements, product specification, design decisions, implementation planning, build execution, testing, defect handling, versioning, change control, release-candidate preparation, and technical or production documentation.

Only an authorized Product Brief or other formally approved solution mandate may enter The Forge. The Forge must preserve traceability to the originating Case, evidence baseline, governing decisions, and approved scope.

The Forge may return work when requirements are inadequate, evidence is insufficient, scope is contradictory, or acceptance conditions cannot be met.

Primary handoff: accepted release candidates, release evidence, operating documentation, and known limitations to The Marketplace.

5. The Marketplace

Mission: Place approved products before the people they are intended to help and operate the commercial interface around them.

The Marketplace owns positioning, offer construction, pricing execution, sales assets, channels, launch execution, distribution, customer-facing product information, transaction support, release communication, and market-performance evidence.

The Marketplace may not redefine the governed problem, silently change the product promise, or release an unaccepted product. Material promise, price, audience, or channel changes must remain connected to the authorized product and founder direction.

Primary handoff: customer activity, sales evidence, market signals, support issues, and promise-performance evidence to The Department of the Ombudsman.

6. The Department of the Ombudsman

Mission: Protect the integrity of the relationship between The Fixer's Desk and the people affected by its work.

The Department of the Ombudsman owns unified intake and classification of feedback, complaints, support friction, harm signals, accessibility concerns, unmet expectations, outcome evidence, and improvement proposals.

It evaluates whether the organization delivered what it promised and whether the solution is useful, fair, understandable, maintainable, and safe enough for continued operation.

The Ombudsman may escalate urgent harm or integrity concerns directly to The Director's Office. It routes validated learning to:

- The Marketplace for communication, offer, channel, or support corrections;
- The Forge for product defects, successor versions, or retirement work;
- Casework when evidence changes the understanding or disposition of the underlying problem; and
- The Watch when feedback reveals a broader or newly emerging problem pattern.

Primary handoff: governed findings, escalations, and improvement recommendations to the responsible department and The Director's Office when founder judgment is required.

Canonical operating loop

The normal operating loop is:

The Watch -> Casework -> The Director's Office -> The Forge -> The Marketplace -> The Department of the Ombudsman -> The Watch / Casework / The Director's Office / The Forge / The Marketplace

The loop is not mechanically linear. Work may pause, close, return, split, merge, or bypass product creation when the governing Case supports another outcome.

Stage 1 - Observe

The Watch captures a traceable signal and preserves its source.

Stage 2 - Govern the problem

Casework determines whether the signal should become or join a Case, develops the evidence, records decisions, and prepares founder-ready work.

Stage 3 - Direct

The Director's Office presents the decision. Deidra authorizes, returns, redirects, pauses, closes, or prioritizes the work.

Stage 4 - Build

The Forge converts an authorized solution mandate into an accepted release candidate while preserving scope and evidence traceability.

Stage 5 - Place in market

The Marketplace executes the approved offer, release, distribution, and customer-facing operation.

Stage 6 - Learn and protect

The Department of the Ombudsman receives market and user evidence, identifies failures or improvement opportunities, and routes governed learning upstream.

Core artifacts and custody

Each authoritative artifact has one primary custodian.

Artifact	Primary custodian
Problem signal and source record	The Watch
Case and Case history	Casework
Evidence baseline, disposition, founder review, solution-path assessment	Casework
Founder decision and cross-department direction	The Director's Office, linked to the authoritative source record
Product Brief and solution authorization	Casework until accepted handoff; then shared traceability with The Forge
Product specification, build plan, version, test and release evidence	The Forge
Offer, pricing execution, sales assets, channel and launch records	The Marketplace
Feedback, complaint, harm, outcome and improvement records	The Department of the Ombudsman

Dashboards and linked views may project records, but may not become competing sources of truth.

Decision and authority model

Human authority is required for constitutional changes, portfolio commitments, final Case investment decisions, solution authorization, material scope exceptions, release approval, major pricing or promise changes, rollback, and retirement unless a later governing document explicitly delegates that authority.

Departments may:

- prepare recommendations;
- enforce their own acceptance standards;
- return incomplete handoffs;
- block advancement when governing requirements are unmet; and
- escalate conflicts to The Director's Office.

A department may not silently seize another department's authority or alter another department's authoritative records to manufacture agreement.

Handoff standard

A valid handoff must identify:

- the sending and receiving departments;
- the authoritative records being transferred or referenced;
- the decision or work requested;
- the evidence and governing authority;
- acceptance conditions;
- known limitations, unresolved questions, and risks;
- responsible owner; and
- the response, acceptance, return, or rejection record.

The sending department remains responsible for the accuracy of what it supplied. The receiving department is responsible for confirming that the handoff is sufficient before accepting responsibility for the next stage.

Work preparation standard

Alex should advance work as far as possible before presenting it to Deidra. Founder queues should contain real decisions, not avoidable clerical work.

A founder-ready item should normally include:

- the decision requested;
- a concise recommendation;
- the governing evidence and relevant history;
- meaningful alternatives;
- risks and reversibility;
- resource or capacity implications;
- the consequence of delay or no action; and
- the exact next action that follows each available response.

Portfolio and capacity model

The Fixer's Desk maintains a governed portfolio rather than treating every Case as equally urgent or every approved solution as immediately buildable.

Casework controls the decision-ready Case and Product Brief pipeline. The Director's Office controls founder prioritization and exceptions. The Forge controls active build capacity. The Marketplace controls launch and channel capacity. The Department of the Ombudsman controls unresolved integrity and improvement load.

The initial objective is 50 founder-ready Cases. This is a prepared decision portfolio, not a requirement to authorize 50 products.

Preservation and learning

The Fixer's Desk preserves institutional memory.

- Cases are not deleted merely because no product is built.
- Evidence baselines and final decisions remain historically attributable.
- Corrections, reversals, returns, supersessions, successor versions, archives, and reopenings preserve lineage.
- Feedback and negative outcomes remain visible.
- Repeated friction becomes governed improvement work.
- Learning must return to the department capable of acting on it.

Solo-production controls

The current production model assumes Deidra is the sole human editor and Alex operates through connected tools under Deidra's authority.

Until multi-person operation is explicitly approved:

- no secondary editor is treated as an authorized operator;
- database locks are accidental-edit safeguards, not permission boundaries;
- role separation is procedural and architectural rather than fully enforced by Notion permissions;
- sensitive or restricted evidence must not be represented as technically isolated unless it actually is;
- founder decisions must remain explicit; and
- future team roles must be added by delegation into this model rather than by creating conflicting departmental structures.

Deferred multi-person model

Multi-person staffing, granular permissions, protected-record enforcement, employee operating roles, workload assignment, and inter-person review controls are deferred.

When activated, those controls must preserve:

- the six institutional departments;
- The Director's Office as the founder's primary operating surface;
- one authoritative source for each governed artifact;
- explicit decision authority;
- complete handoff and history records; and
- the problem-first Case-centered operating loop.

Operating success standard

The operating model is successful when:

- Alex can continuously develop governed Case pipelines from observed problems;
- Deidra can make the necessary decisions primarily from The Director's Office;
- authorized work moves into The Forge without missing context or invented process;
- accepted products move through The Marketplace with traceable promises and release authority;
- feedback and harm signals enter The Department of the Ombudsman and produce governed responses;
- learning returns upstream without erasing history;
- the command "**Alex, make 50 Cases and put them in my office**" produces a usable founder decision portfolio; and
- normal solo production does not require Deidra to operate every departmental back office or invent missing workflow.

Conformance rule

All current-target Fixer's Desk documentation, tasks, navigation, databases, views, handoffs, and acceptance tests must use these institutional department names:

- 1 The Watch
- 2 Casework
- 3 The Director's Office
- 4 The Forge
- 5 The Marketplace
- 6 The Department of the Ombudsman

Former department names may remain only in clearly labeled historical records, migration notes, or supersession lineage.